Frog Logic

Sensory Differences

A POND GUIDE

Most people know about the five senses. Sensory processing differences involve eight — and any of them can arrive far too loud, far too quiet, or unpredictably both.

In plain words

Sensory processing describes how the brain receives and interprets information from the senses — including balance, body position, and internal signals like hunger or needing the loo. Some people are hypersensitive, receiving too much; some are hyposensitive, receiving too little and seeking more. Many are both, in different senses, on different days.

What it can feel like from the inside

- A supermarket being genuinely painful rather than mildly annoying.
- A clothing label feeling like it's actively attacking you.
- Craving deep pressure, loud music or strong flavours to feel switched on.
- Not registering hunger, thirst or cold until it's become urgent.
- The same environment being fine on Tuesday and unbearable on Thursday.

What people often get wrong

THE ASSUMPTION	WHAT'S ACTUALLY GOING ON
"They're being fussy."	The distress is real and physical. Nobody chooses this over a comfortable jumper.
"They'll get used to it."	Forced exposure usually sensitises further rather than habituating.
"It's only about noise."	Eight senses, including balance, body position and internal signals.
"They were fine last week."	Sensory tolerance moves with tiredness, stress, hormones and illness.
"Ear defenders are antisocial."	They're the reason the person can stay at all.

What often comes with it

NOT COMPENSATION PRIZES — GENUINE, USEFUL THINGS

Noticing things nobody else registers.

Deep enjoyment of textures, sounds and tastes others find ordinary.

Excellent early warning for problems — the smell, the sound, the flicker.

Strong aesthetic sense and attention to environment.

Real skill at designing spaces that work for people.

What actually helps

- ☐ Ask before changing the environment
- ☐ Offer a quieter room as standard
- ☐ Warn before loud or bright things
- ☐ Let them wear the ear defenders
- ☐ Don't comment on food or clothing choices
- ☐ Believe them the first time

If someone tells you this is them

HELPFUL

"Is this alright in here?"

"Want the lights down?"

"We can go whenever."

LESS HELPFUL

"It's not that loud."

"You'll get used to it."

"Just try a bit."

Not fussy. Receiving a different amount of the world than you are.

A friendly explainer written for the community — not a diagnostic tool and not medical advice. If you want an assessment, your GP is the place to start. Nobody experiences this identically, so take what fits and leave the rest.

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